



Just beer keyboard

We're not sure whether this keyboard does exist or not, but this picture is worth checking out.



Nexus 4 hits India

We know you were waiting for that. A much awaited Nexus 4 finally reached India, with a price tag of Rs. 25,999. <http://dgit.in/16yrXEY>

The advantage of a 10-inch form factor comes into play if you are one who consumes a lot of multimedia content and needs to type on a tablet. Playing games and watching movies is a lot more entertaining on the larger display and typing in landscape mode too becomes easier.

The choice between a 7-inch or larger form factor is a very subjective decision. If you are looking for a tablet to carry on the go with the ability to fit in the breast pocket of your jacket, then a 7-inch device is the one for you. But if a large display or rather iPad equivalent tablet is what you are looking for, then a larger tablet is the device for you. Apart from the above-mentioned tablets, the rest of the devices bring a very generic build.

TABLETS UP TO ₹10,000

The sub 10K price point can be considered as "testing the tablet waters" for consumers. Here you get an absolute entry-level device – single-core (maybe the odd dual-core) processor, 7-inch display with a 480x800 resolution, standard array of ports (microUSB, HDMI Out, DC IN, memory card slot) and more. Some of the tablets even show off the ability to make calls by housing a SIM card.

The UI of these tablets is similar to each other; almost stock Android with a minimalist skin. The UI or preloaded apps in this category isn't the distinguishing factor. In some cases even the hardware powering the tablets are the same. It is with the hardware optimisation and performance of the touchscreen and display that influences the people who buy these tablets.



Lava E-Tab Xtron

Display performance Visual

With the exception of the Karbonn Smart Tab 10, all the tablets in this price bracket have a 7-inch display. The display is a TFT LCD display in most cases with the WickedLeak Wammy Desire II and the Lava E-Tab Xtron boasting of IPS panels. Most of the budget tablets do not have a protective coating on the display, which means that it can get scratched very easily.

Another problem plaguing the display is that most of them suffer from really bad viewing angles. You need to hold it at a specific position to get the right colour reproduction. A slight shift and it is difficult to see what is happening on the display.

From the sub 10k price point, there are only a few tablets that really stood out. To start with, the Lava E-Tab Xtron is one, which has a dimmer display when compared to the competition, but it is very clear. It has better viewing angles that what we have seen from a 7k device.

Another tablet that has a really bright display is the Penta T-Pad EDGE. Of all the tablets the one that really stood out in terms of the display has to be the WickedLeak Wammy Desire II – its resolution is the highest in price point and the viewing angles are great too. The display is really vibrant and stands out when you switch on all the devices and place them next to each other.

Interface

Intex iBuddy 3 has quite an unresponsive display when it comes to the touchscreen. You really have to make an effort to navigate it and it is quite a frustrating experience. The Mercury Mtab 7 is no better. It lags less than the iBuddy but is still laggy itself. Even though the keyboard responds to your touch, the experience isn't the smoothest, again thanks to the lag. Despite the dual-core processor, the interface of the Zync Dual 7 is plagued with lag as well. You really have to make an effort to type on these devices. The Videocon VT 75C has a slightly better touch response than the above, but it isn't grand by any standards.

The Lava E-Tab Xtron is one tablet that has a really smooth interface. It is one of the tablets that justifies its dual-core processor and 1GB RAM. The interface is smooth, navigating the tablet is nice, and lag is only a problem when you multitask heavily on it. The keyboard is one of the smoother and better ones in its segment. You won't be typing pages of documents on this device but it has a good keyboards and touch interface.

AOC's Breeze MG97DR-16 and Micromax's Funbook 3G have a similar interface with the touchscreen – responsive and

working like your run of the mill average Android device.

The best display on a device in this category is the WickedLeak Wammy Desire II. The interface is butter smooth and very crisp. The keyboard in portrait mode is laid out very well, just like a smartphone and is comfortable to hold, and continues to be easy to type on in landscape mode. The curved smartphone-like design makes it easier to hold and type on. The device isn't plagued with lag and has quite a smooth interface.

The Acer Iconia B1 too is a tablet that has a very smooth touch interface. There is considerably less lag here when compared to the cheapest tablets in this list, and the interface feels heavenly. The downside to the B1 is that it doesn't seem to support 720p HD MKV video properly, regardless of what video player we used.

If a 10-inch tablet is what you desire then the Karbonn Smart Tab 10 is the device for you. The resolution is low which is a hindrance if you consume multimedia content, but the keyboard is well laid out and good to type on.

Unique features and UI

Since all the tablets run on Android, their core interface is the same. Still some of these devices try to bring something new to the table such as their own app store, different colours and styles for the icons, preloaded apps and more. Most of the things are quite generic. Here we will talk about what caught our eye and what distinguished some devices from the others.

To start with, the Karbonn Smart Tab 10 has a stock Android experience. A great thing about the interface on the tablet is that it is the same as the